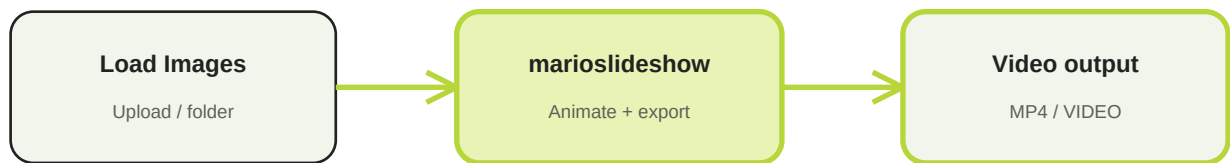


marioslideshow

High-energy photo promo animation for ComfyUI

This guide explains how to install, operate, and get the best results from the marioslideshow custom node. It renders a procedural 2D motion-design slideshow locally, with no diffusion model or cloud service required.



Quick start

1. Restart ComfyUI after installation and refresh the browser with Ctrl+F5.
2. Load **examples/high_energy.json** or add the nodes from the marioslideshow category.
3. Click **Upload images**, select several photos, and connect the photos output to the main node if using the loader.
4. Choose the output format, pacing, layout, and quality, then queue the prompt.
5. Preview the video inside the node and download the MP4.

Recommended first render: 1280 x 720, 30 FPS, BPM timing, 128 BPM, 4 beats per image, Dynamic pacing, Art directed mix, Smart fit, Mixed transitions, Standard motion blur, High quality.

Installation

The installed extension is located at:

```
E:\ComfyUI_windows_portable\ComfyUI\custom_nodes\marioslideshow
```

If you need to install it again, place the folder inside ComfyUI/custom_nodes and install its requirements with the Python environment that launches ComfyUI:

```
E:\ComfyUI_windows_portable\python_embeded\python.exe -m pip install -r
E:\ComfyUI_windows_portable\ComfyUI\custom_nodes\marioslideshow\requirements.txt
```

Always restart ComfyUI after copying or changing a custom node. A red node with UNKNOWN fields means the workflow was opened before the extension was loaded; restart and reload the workflow.

The nodes

Node	Purpose
marioslideshow - Load Images	Loads up to 200 images from an uploaded folder, creates a contact sheet, and outputs a photo collection.
marioslideshow	Builds the animation, encodes the MP4, saves a poster and metadata JSON, and outputs a native VIDEO.
marioslideshow - Extract Frames	Extracts a limited frame range from the native video into an IMAGE batch.
Standard video nodes	The VIDEO output can connect to Save Video, Get Video Components, Video Slice, and other compatible nodes.

Loading images

The main node accepts exactly one image source:

- Upload images: click the Upload images button and select multiple PNG, JPEG, WebP, BMP, or TIFF files.
- Folder path: enter an absolute path or a path relative to ComfyUI/input.
- IMAGE batch: connect another ComfyUI node that outputs IMAGE.

Do not connect more than one source. Folder loading is non-recursive. Natural order treats image2 as earlier than image10. The Load Images node also offers Newest first.

Mixed portrait and landscape photos are supported. Use Smart fit to preserve images against a softened background, Contain to preserve the whole photo, or Fill to crop edge-to-edge.

Output format

Use	Width	Height	FPS
Landscape / YouTube	1920	1080	30
Vertical / TikTok / Reels	1080	1920	30
Square	1080	1080	30
Fast preview	960	540	24 or 30

Width and height must be even numbers for MP4 encoding. Higher resolution and Fine motion blur take longer because rendering runs on the CPU.

Timing and pacing

Control	How it works	Suggested use
Timing: BPM	Calculates each shot from BPM and beats per image.	Use with music.
Timing: Seconds	Uses seconds per image directly.	Use for exact duration.
BPM	Musical tempo from 20 to 300.	120-140 for promo edits.
Beats per image	Length of each full shot in beats.	2-4 for energy; 8 for slower work.
Seconds per image	Fixed shot length from 0.4 to 30 seconds.	Use with Seconds timing.
Dynamic	Alternates full and half-length shots.	Recommended for high energy.
Even	Every image has equal duration.	Use for simple galleries.

Example: at 128 BPM and 4 beats per image, one full shot is approximately $60 / 128 \times 4 = 1.875$ seconds. Dynamic pacing creates shorter shots between full shots for rhythmic variation.

Layouts

- Art directed mix: alternates hero shots, split screens, three-panel layouts, and layered photo stacks. Best default.
- Full frame: one photo fills the entire frame with eased camera movement.
- Layered: overlapping photo cards, rotations, shadows, and graphic depth.
- Split screen: asymmetric panels with animated movement and accent marks.

Transitions and motion

Control	Effect
Mixed	Cycles through whip, zoom, diagonal, shutter, and impact transitions.
Whip	Fast horizontal movement between photos.
Zoom	Scale punch with a smooth blend.
Diagonal	Angled reveal wipe.
Shutter	Staggered vertical panel reveal.
Impact	Short punch-in and flash-like hit.
Cut	Instant edit with no transition.
Transition seconds	Usually 0.18-0.32 seconds for a promo.
Intensity	Controls camera movement, zoom, rotation, and transition strength.
Motion blur	Off, Standard 3 samples, or Fine 5 samples.
Grain	Subtle texture, usually 0.03-0.10.

The camera animation uses eased subpixel movement. Motion blur is temporal supersampling: nearby frames are blended to make fast movement feel more like a composited motion-design shot.

Graphics and headlines

Graphics add a shot counter, accent progress line, accent bars, and a headline underline. Disable graphics for a clean photo-only export.

Enter one headline per image, one line at a time. Blank lines are allowed. Headlines follow their images when Shuffle is enabled. Long text wraps and scales to stay inside the safe area.

Example:

```
MARIO
IN MOTION
A NEW ANGLE

FRAME BY FRAME
MAKE IT MOVE
```

Audio and export

Audio can be supplied either through the `audio_file` path or through the AUDIO socket. Use one method, not both. Short audio is padded with silence; long audio is trimmed to the video length and encoded as AAC.

Without a beats connection, set BPM manually. The optional Beat Analyzer added in the modular upgrade detects soundtrack markers. Connect the soundtrack separately to the renderer too.

Quality	Use
Preview	Fast timing and composition checks.
High	Recommended final export.
Master	Higher H.264 quality, slower encoding; still compressed, not lossless.

Output files are written to:

```
E:\ComfyUI_windows_portable\ComfyUI\output\marioslideshow
```

- MP4 video
- JPG poster frame
- JSON render manifest with settings, image order, headlines, and shot start frames

The node also displays an embedded video player and Download MP4 link after rendering.

Recommended recipes

High-energy promo

1920x1080, 30 FPS, BPM 128, 4 beats per image, Dynamic, Art directed mix, Smart fit, Mixed transitions, 0.28 transition seconds, intensity 0.75, Standard motion blur, grain 0.06, High quality.

Vertical social video

1080x1920, 30 FPS, Smart fit, Art directed mix, Mixed transitions, intensity 0.65-0.80. Use shorter 2-beat shots for fast social edits.

Clean editorial gallery

1920x1080, Even pacing, Layered or Full frame, Zoom transitions, intensity 0.40-0.60, grain 0.03, graphics disabled.

Shuffle and seed

Shuffle changes the image order. Seed makes the shuffle and transition variation repeatable. Reuse the same seed to recreate an edit; change it to generate another arrangement.

Troubleshooting

- UNKNOWN fields or red nodes: restart ComfyUI and press Ctrl+F5.
- No images found: confirm the folder exists and contains supported formats.
- Exactly one source error: clear image_folder when using photos or IMAGE.
- More headline lines than images: remove extra lines.
- Slow render: use Preview, turn motion blur Off, lower resolution, or reduce image count.
- Cropped subject: switch framing to Smart fit or Contain.
- FFmpeg error: install requirements with ComfyUI's embedded Python.

Limitations: marioslideshow is a procedural 2D compositor. It does not create AI cutouts, 3D depth or editable After Effects projects. The modular upgrade adds beat analysis, guided framing and editable shot plans; see the following pages.

Modular upgrade

Your original node remains available. Four additional nodes separate soundtrack analysis, framing, planning and rendering. Find them under marioslideshow / advanced.

Node	Purpose
Beat Analyzer	Detects music beat timestamps; outputs beats, BPM, waveform preview and JSON.
Subject Framer	Guides framing using frontal faces, supplied masks or manual focus. Outputs focus and a preview.
Director	Creates an editable shot plan, timeline preview and duration.
Renderer	Renders the Director plan to MP4 using the original animation engine.

First modular render

- Load examples/modular_high_energy.json, upload photos in Load Images, select a Director preset, and Run.
- Load Images.photos connects to both Subject Framer.photos and Renderer.photos. image_count connects to Director.image_count.
- Subject Framer.focus connects to Renderer.focus. Director.plan connects to Renderer.plan.

Presets

Preset	Scene and transition choices
High energy	Hero, split, stack, triptych and mosaic; strong pushes, pulls, pans and snap settles.
Luxury editorial	Light gallery mattes, hero and split; restrained motion with cuts, dissolves and diagonal reveals.
Cinematic gallery	Dark gallery/window framing and hero; gentle motion with dissolves and cuts.
Hard-cut promo	Hero and multi-panel scenes with direct cuts.

Presets select composition, camera path, motion strength and Dynamic pacing. Seed varies the arrangement; shuffle also changes source order. Renderer intensity multiplies preset strength. Recent layout repeats are discouraged instead of following a short fixed loop.

Install requirements-advanced.txt with ComfyUI's Python for librosa and scikit-image. No model download or paid service is required.

Music and subject framing

Music workflow

- Load `examples/modular_music.json` and choose/upload a soundtrack in Load Audio. AUDIO is wired to BOTH Analyzer and Renderer; `Analyzer.beats` feeds `Director.beats`.
- `tempo_hint = 0` estimates BPM. Enter the known BPM to correct half/double-tempo detection.
`beat_offset_seconds` shifts markers, not the audio.
- Use `whole_beats_per_image` with detected beats. Dynamic uses seeded short runs and longer holds; calm presets favor longer shots. This is procedural pacing, not song-section detection. Connected beats override manual BPM/Seconds timing.
- `max_seconds` controls analysis length (180 by default, up to 600). Too few markers: reduce beats per image/image count or analyze more audio.

Video starts at zero. Later shot boundaries use detected timestamps rounded to frames. Transitions begin on the selected markers; the first shot includes the initial track offset. Detection is approximate and does not identify sections or drops. Inspect and listen to the result.

Subject Framer

- Use the same source collection and order for Framer and Renderer. Green boxes show protected areas; red crosses show focus. The preview displays the first 12 images; all images are processed.
- Faces detects frontal faces locally. Center fallback is used when no face is found. `subject_margin` expands detected regions.
- Manual uses `focus_x/focus_y` from 0 to 1. `overrides_json` can target a zero-based source index:
`{"0":{"x":0.8,"y":0.3}}`.
- Optional masks require one per image: white means subject, black means background. Masks take priority over face detection. Invert transparency masks when necessary.

Smart fit can contain the photo when the protected region will not fit a crop. Fill may crop oversized regions. This is crop guidance, not a universal object detector or a foreground cutout system; transitions and overlapping layers can still occlude subjects.

Editing the shot plan

- Run once, then click Edit generated plan on Director. Its JSON is copied into timeline_json_in.
- Edit shot order, image_index, duration, scene, incoming transition or headline. You can repeat images or remove shots. Image indices start at zero.

Field	Allowed values
version / source_count	version 1; source_count must match the loaded collection, even when some photos are unused.
image_index	Zero-based source image index.
duration	0.4-120 seconds per shot; up to 200 shots.
scene	hero, split, triptych, stack, gallery, window, mosaic
transition	cut, whip, zoom, diagonal, shutter, impact, dissolve
Optional motion fields	motion: push, pull, left, right, rise, snap, hold. strength: 0-1. variant: integer 0-7. Older plans remain supported.
headline	Text, up to 240 characters per shot; empty is allowed.

Nonempty timeline_json_in overrides preset, timing, shuffle and headlines, including beats. Click Use preset / clear custom plan to regenerate. Changing preset with a custom plan active displays a warning and preserves your edits. Manual edits do not preserve beat alignment automatically.

Keep the simple workflow

You can connect Beat Analyzer.beats and/or Subject Framer.focus directly to the original marioslideshow node. Existing required controls and outputs are unchanged. The Director plan uses the new Renderer.

Troubleshooting

- Red or UNKNOWN nodes: restart ComfyUI and hard-refresh the browser. Check startup logs for missing dependencies.
- Preset changes do nothing: clear timeline_json_in. Mismatched plan/focus counts: connect the same collection throughout.
- No soundtrack: AUDIO must reach Renderer too. Leave audio_file empty when AUDIO is connected.
- Missed face or product: use manual focus, per-image overrides or subject masks.

UPGRADE_GUIDE.md contains complete wiring, a copy-ready JSON example and detailed limits. Output manifests store the shot plan and framing data alongside render settings.

Counters and free-position text

These controls are available on both the original marioslideshow node and the advanced Renderer. Existing workflows need no rewiring.

Control	Result
show_counter = false	Hide the current-shot / total-shot numbers.
show_progress = false	Hide the line at the bottom of the video.
show_headlines = false	Hide all headlines without deleting their settings.
graphics = false	Hide counters, progress and accent graphics; headline text remains independent.

Edit headlines

- Click Edit headlines, then Add headline. Drag the text into position or set X/Y percentages. These coordinates locate the top-left of its text box.
- Each headline has independent Start and End times in seconds from the beginning of the entire video. Several headlines can appear together or enter at different times.
- Width controls the text box; Size is a percentage of the shorter video dimension. Choose color, alignment and fade, slide or no animation. Long text wraps/shrinks to fit the remaining frame.
- Use the timeline slider to inspect active headlines. Selecting a layer jumps to its time. A layer can span multiple images, and does not follow a source image when shuffled.
- Add up to 200 layers. Duplicate, Delete and Visible apply to the selected layer. Later layers paint over earlier ones. Apply saves; Close or Escape cancels.

Custom headline layers replace the automatic per-image headlines. Delete all custom layers and Apply to restore automatic headlines. Times beyond the end of the video are not visible.

The canvas uses browser typography with an optional still poster from the last render. It is not a live preview of each shot. The exported video uses font_path and is the final typography reference.

Restart ComfyUI after installation, then press Ctrl+F5 in its browser tab to load the new controls.